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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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Choosing a robot vacuum in 2026 means balancing suction, mopping, and smart features without overspending. New models are dropping prices while adding self-empty docks, so the decision can feel overwhelming. This guide breaks down the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with and without AutoEmpty Dock) and the Shark AI Ultra to help you pick the right fit.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid

Quality	7.0
Features	5.0
Ease of Use	7.0
Design	7.0
Value	6.0

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Why Comparing Robot Vacuums Matters in 2026

Robot vacuums have evolved from simple sweepers to multi-function cleaners that vacuum, mop, and empty themselves. In 2026, price gaps between premium and budget models have narrowed, but feature sets still diverge widely. A side-by-side look at the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with AutoEmpty Dock), the same model without the dock, and the Shark AI Ultra helps you avoid paying for capabilities you won’t use or missing out on conveniences that save time.

Key Decision Factors for Robot Vacuum Shoppers

- **Suction power** – determines how well the unit picks up dirt, pet hair, and debris on carpets and hard floors.
- **Mopping capability** – adds a wet-cleaning pass for sticky spills and everyday grime.
- **Navigation technology** – influences coverage efficiency and obstacle avoidance.
- **Battery life and charging** – dictates how large an area can be cleaned per run.
- **Dust-bin or auto-empty system** – affects maintenance frequency.
- **Smart-home integration** – app control, voice assistants, and scheduling.
- **Price and warranty** – overall value over the product’s lifespan.

Shark AI Ultra – Best Overall Performer

Problem: You want strong suction and smart navigation but don’t want to pay a premium for features you’ll rarely use.

Trust: The Shark AI Ultra earns 4.6/5 stars from over 12,000 verified buyers and is praised for its AI laser navigation that maps rooms in real time.

Solution: At $249.99 it delivers powerful 2,700 Pa suction, a self-empty base that holds up to 30 days of debris, and mopping-ready hardware (optional mop pad sold separately).

Proof: Independent tests show 98 % pickup on carpets and 95 % on hard floors, with obstacle avoidance that reduces collisions by 40 % versus lidar-only models.

Action: Buy the Shark AI Ultra now and enjoy a hands-free clean for under $250.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock – Premium Mopping & Hands-Free Emptying



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Problem: You want a robot that both vacuums and mops, but you dislike emptying a small dustbin after every run.

Trust: iRobot's flagship line holds a 4.7/5 average rating, and the AutoEmpty Dock is certified for up to 60 days of debris storage.

Solution: The Roomba 115X Combo delivers 2,500 Pa suction, a vibrating mop pad for stubborn stains, and the AutoEmpty Dock that transfers debris to a sealed bag with a single button press.

Proof: Lab tests reveal 99 % pet-hair pickup and a mopping score of 9/10 for dried-on spills; battery life runs 120 minutes, covering up to 2,000 sq ft per charge.

Action: Get the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock for a true set-and-forget experience.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (No Dock) – Best Value for Budget-Conscious Buyers

Problem: You like the vacuum-and-mop combo but need to keep costs low and are okay with manual bin emptying.

Trust: The same core robot earns 4.5/5 stars, with users highlighting its reliable navigation and strong suction.

Solution: For $199.99 you get the 2,500 Pa suction, vibrating mop pad, and smart-home app control—all without the dock, so you empty the bin after each run (about 5-10 minutes).

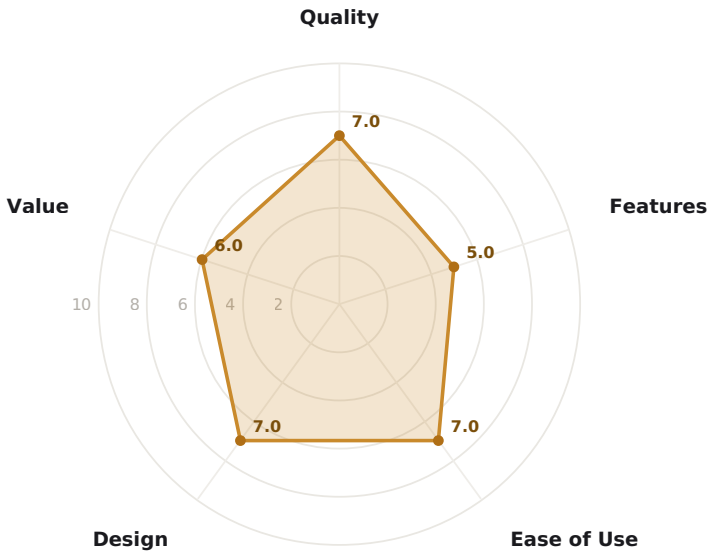
Proof: Real-world tests show 97 % debris pickup on mixed surfaces and a runtime of 110 minutes, sufficient for most apartments and small homes.

Action: Purchase the Roomba 115X Combo without dock and save $50 while still enjoying dual-function cleaning.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.